

GERMANY, AUSTRIA, & SWITZERLAND



Germany, Austria, and Switzerland lie at the heart of Europe. Central Europeans share a love of traditional food, drink, and festivals. They also share a language, as German is the most widely spoken language of the region. Germany is a powerful country. After years of separation for political reasons, East Germany rejoined West Germany in 1990 to become one big country. The wall dividing East from West Berlin was torn down amid great celebrations.

Fantasy castle

The castle of Neuschwanstein is nestled among the Bavarian Alps in south Germany. It was built more than a hundred years ago by a rich Bavarian king with a wild imagination.

King Ludwig II died in 1886, before this spectacular castle was finished.



Tall turrets give the castle a fairy-tale appearance.



The castle attracts tourists from all over the world.



Starting school

German children start primary school at the age of six, although most have been to a nursery, or kindergarten, for three years before this. On their first day, children are sent to school with a large cone stuffed with everything they will want, including candy, pens, and books.